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Climate change and climate change impacts on São Tomé and Príncipe with a focus on fishery and tourism sectors in a Blue Economy context

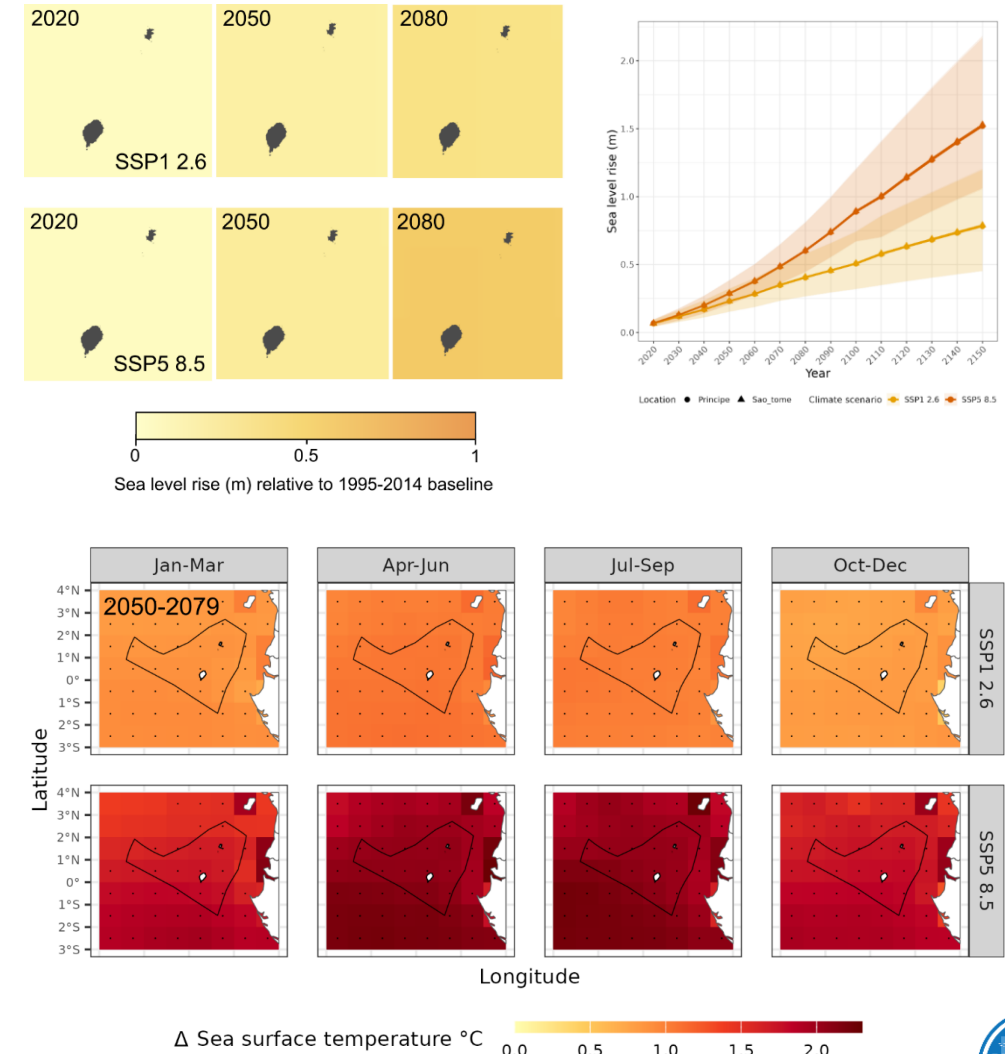
Sao Tome and Principe, November/December 2025

ADAPTATION RECOMMENDATIONS

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Summary of report findings

- Future climate change is expected to affect both tourism and blue economy:
 - Sea level rise
 - Increased tourist discomfort
 - Reduction in EEZ fish biomass
 - Alterations to probability of pelagic and demersal occurrence in EEZ and species
- An adaptation strategy to mitigate the impacts of climate change is needed

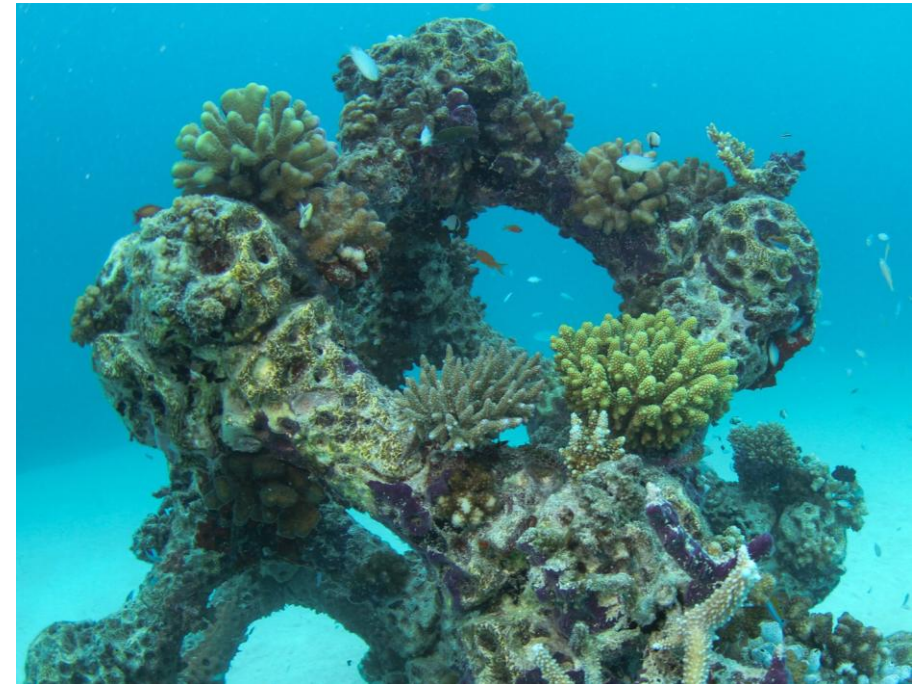


Tourism adaptation recommendations – coastal erosion

- WACA+ recommendations to mitigate coastal erosion impact:
 - Construction of dikes, breakwaters (e.g gabions), and protective walls in most vulnerable areas.
 - Creating safe expansion zones for coastal communities.
 - Establishment of a climate alert system on the state of the sea
 - Rehabilitation of tide stations
 - Sand dredging to repair eroded beaches
 - Diversification of activities and support measures for populations whose livelihoods depend on coastal activities
 - Construction of drainage ditches and water tanks

Tourism adaptation recommendations – eco-tourism

- Coral reef restoration:
 - Cultivating healthy coral fragments in nurseries until they reach an appropriate size and then transplanting into the damaged reef.
 - Small pieces of coral broken up by storms or human activity can be fixed to degraded reefs.
 - Installation of artificial reefs



Tourism adaptation recommendations – eco-tourism

- Code of Conduct for Sustainable Diving:
 - Limitations on the number of divers per site or per day;
 - Prohibition of coral contact or the use of overly aggressive fins;
 - Mandatory use of **reef-safe sunscreen**;
 - Sustainable anchoring practices (use of buoys instead of anchors to avoid seabed damage);
 - Education for tourists and guides on the environmental impact of their actions.
- Regulatory framework:
 - Licensing or authorisation for dive operators;
 - Minimum sustainability and safety criteria;
 - Designation of **no-fishing** or **restricted recreational zones** in the most sensitive reefs;
 - Monitoring, enforcement, and sanctions for proven environmental damage.

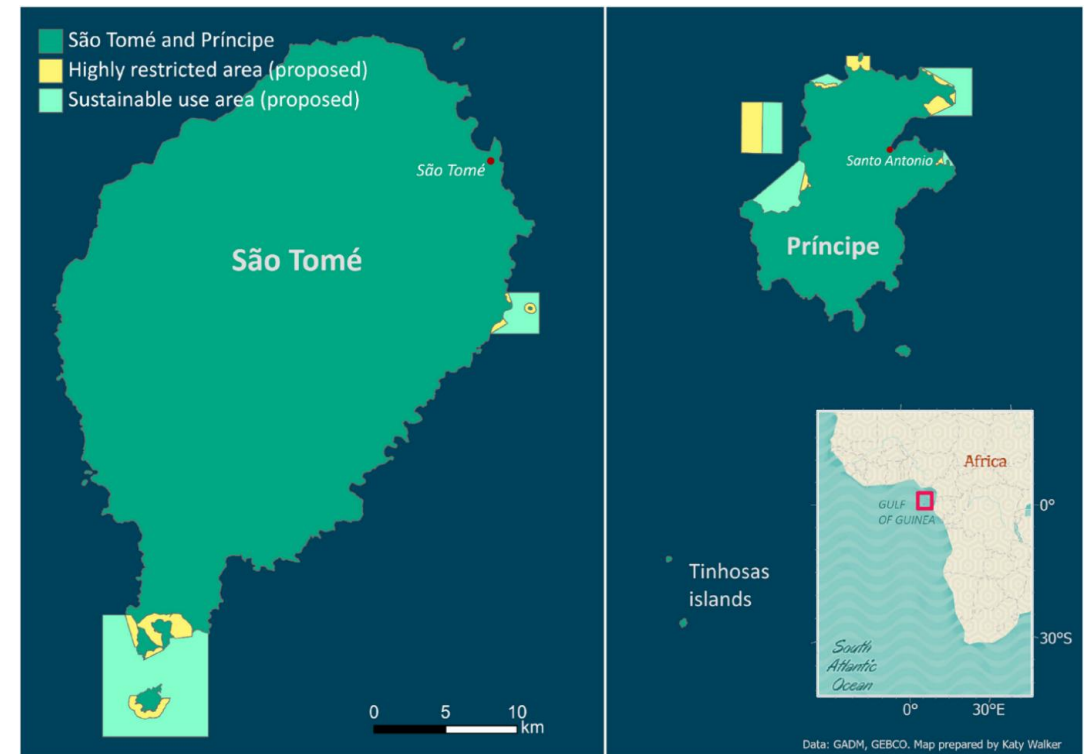
Fisheries adaptation recommendations – infrastructure

- Construction of additional fishing ports
- Building of district retail markets with adequate refrigeration equipment (ice and cold storage, freezers)
- Construction of a workshop for the construction of improved fishing boats
- Build a manufacturing unit for essential fishing materials (nets, mooring lines, cables, hooks, etc.)
- Development of official food storage and preparation hygiene rules.
- Development of road networks between fishing ports and markets and investment in refrigerated vehicles for safe fish transport.



Fisheries adaptation recommendations – protection of fish species

- Further development and enforcement of marine protected areas (MPAs).
- Responsible use of moored fish aggregating devices (FADs).
- Regulatory framework to avoid over-fishing:
 - Returning juveniles
 - Use of unweighted purse seine fishing methods
 - Catch limits
 - Limits on number of fishing vessels



Tourism and fisheries adaptation recommendations – sports fishing

- Creation of sport fishing zones based on existing ecological studies
- Compulsory licenses for amateur and sport fishing
- Respect for the closed season (breeding seasons)
- Catch limits and minimum sizes
- Prohibition of fishing endangered species
- Recording of catches and shipments
- Require certified guides and safe, seaworthy vessels.
- Environmental and maritime inspection.





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Merci
Thank you